SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Protected Area Network India - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Protected Area Network India - Solved Practice Workbook

Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-06. Uses the same source-bounded ecological distinctions and strict A-B-C-D rotation.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Four protected-area categories?

A. The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category. B. A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification. C. A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. D. A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q2. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Four protected-area categories?

A. A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. B. The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category. C. A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. D. A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q3. Which statement uses Four protected-area categories without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. B. A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. C. The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category. D. Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Four protected-area categories?

A. A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. B. Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area. C. The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories. D. The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category. The other

options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies National Park?

A. A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification. B. A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. C. A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. D. A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role.

Answer: A. Explanation: A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q6. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of National Park?

A. A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. B. A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification. C. A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. D. Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area.

Answer: B. Explanation: A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q7. Which statement uses National Park without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. B. Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area. C. A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification. D. The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories.

Answer: C. Explanation: A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about National Park?

A. Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area. B. The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories. C. A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. D. A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification.

Answer: D. Explanation: A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Wildlife Sanctuary?

A. A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. B. A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. C. A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. D. Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area.

Answer: A. Explanation: A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q10. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Wildlife Sanctuary?

A. A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. B. A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. C. Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area. D. The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories.

Answer: B. Explanation: A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q11. Which statement uses Wildlife Sanctuary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area. B. The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories. C. A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. D. A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status.

Answer: C. Explanation: A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Wildlife Sanctuary?

A. The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories. B. A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. C. The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. D. A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park.

Answer: D. Explanation: A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Conservation Reserve?

A. A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. B. A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. C. Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area. D. The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories.

Answer: A. Explanation: A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q14. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Conservation Reserve?

A. Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area. B. A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. C. The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories. D. A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status.

Answer: B. Explanation: A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q15. Which statement uses Conservation Reserve without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories. B. A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. C. A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. D. The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific.

Answer: C. Explanation: A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Conservation Reserve?

A. A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. B. The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. C. The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. D. A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities.

Answer: D. Explanation: A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Community Reserve?

A. A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. B. Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area. C. The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories. D. A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status.

Answer: A. Explanation: A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q18. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Community Reserve?

A. The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories. B. A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. C. A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. D. The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific.

Answer: B. Explanation: A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q19. Which statement uses Community Reserve without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. B. The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. C. A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. D. The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes.

Answer: C. Explanation: A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Community Reserve?

A. The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. B. The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. C. Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable. D. A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role.

Answer: D. Explanation: A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Rights and activity gradient?

A. Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area. B. The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories. C. A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. D. The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific.

Answer: A. Explanation: Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q22. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Rights and activity gradient?

A. A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. B. Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area. C. The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. D. The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes.

Answer: B. Explanation: Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q23. Which statement uses Rights and activity gradient without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. B. The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. C. Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area. D. Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable.

Answer: C. Explanation: Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Rights and activity gradient?

A. The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. B. Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable. C. An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act. D. Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area.

Answer: D. Explanation: Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies 2002 category expansion?

A. The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories. B. A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. C. The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. D. The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q26. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of 2002 category expansion?

A. The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. B. The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories. C. The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. D. Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q27. Which statement uses 2002 category expansion without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. B. Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable. C. The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories. D. An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about 2002 category expansion?

A. Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable. B. An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act. C. ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width. D. The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Tiger Reserve overlay?

A. A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. B. The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. C. The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. D. Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable.

Answer: A. Explanation: A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q30. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Tiger Reserve overlay?

A. The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. B. A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. C. Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable. D. An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act.

Answer: B. Explanation: A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q31. Which statement uses Tiger Reserve overlay without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable. B. An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act. C. A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. D. ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width.

Answer: C. Explanation: A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Tiger Reserve overlay?

A. An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act. B. ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width. C. The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact. D. A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status.

Answer: D. Explanation: A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Critical tiger habitat and buffer?

A. The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. B. The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. C. Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable. D. An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act.

Answer: A. Explanation: The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q34. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Critical tiger habitat and buffer?

A. Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable. B. The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. C. An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act. D. ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width.

Answer: B. Explanation: The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q35. Which statement uses Critical tiger habitat and buffer without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act. B. ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width. C. The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. D. The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact.

Answer: C. Explanation: The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Critical tiger habitat and buffer?

A. ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width. B. The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact. C. Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. D. The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific.

Answer: D. Explanation: The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Relocation and rights?

A. The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. B. Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable. C. An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act. D. ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q38. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Relocation and rights?

A. An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act. B. The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. C. ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width. D. The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q39. Which statement uses Relocation and rights without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width. B. The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact. C. The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. D. Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Relocation and rights?

A. The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact. B. Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. C. The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked. D. The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Elephant landscape distinction?

A. Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable. B. An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act. C. ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width. D. The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact.

Answer: A. Explanation: Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q42. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Elephant landscape distinction?

A. ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width. B. Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable. C. The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact. D. Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape.

Answer: B. Explanation: Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q43. Which statement uses Elephant landscape distinction without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact. B. Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. C. Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable. D. The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked.

Answer: C. Explanation: Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Elephant landscape distinction?

A. Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. B. The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked. C. State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions. D. Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable.

Answer: D. Explanation: Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Eco-Sensitive Zone statute?

A. An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act. B. ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width. C. The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact. D. Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape.

Answer: A. Explanation: An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q46. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Eco-Sensitive Zone statute?

A. The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact. B. An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act. C. Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. D. The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked.

Answer: B. Explanation: An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q47. Which statement uses Eco-Sensitive Zone statute without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. B. The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked. C. An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act. D. State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions.

Answer: C. Explanation: An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Eco-Sensitive Zone statute?

A. The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked. B. State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions. C. An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category. D. An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act.

Answer: D. Explanation: An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies ESZ extent and activities?

A. ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width. B. The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact. C. Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. D. The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked.

Answer: A. Explanation: ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q50. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of ESZ extent and activities?

A. Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. B. ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width. C. The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked. D. State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions.

Answer: B. Explanation: ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q51. Which statement uses ESZ extent and activities without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked. B. State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions. C. ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width. D. An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category.

Answer: C. Explanation: ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about ESZ extent and activities?

A. State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions. B. An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category. C. MoEFCC's retrievable wildlife page confirmed the four categories and protection outside protected areas, but its undated displayed count was not adopted as the latest network total. D. ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width.

Answer: D. Explanation: ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Boundary and surrounding landscape?

A. The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact. B. Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. C. The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked. D. State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions.

Answer: A. Explanation: The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q54. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Boundary and surrounding landscape?

A. The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked. B. The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact. C. State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions. D. An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category.

Answer: B. Explanation: The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q55. Which statement uses Boundary and surrounding landscape without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions. B. An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category. C. The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact. D. MoEFCC's retrievable wildlife page confirmed the four categories and protection outside protected areas, but its undated displayed count was not adopted as the latest network total.

Answer: C. Explanation: The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Boundary and surrounding landscape?

A. An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category. B. MoEFCC's retrievable wildlife page confirmed the four categories and protection outside protected areas, but its undated displayed count was not adopted as the latest network total. C. Routed demands cover named parks, habitats, community-reserve governance and Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar as separate designation functions; no objective key is inferred. D. The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact.

Answer: D. Explanation: The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Connectivity?

A. Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. B. The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked. C. State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions. D. An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category.

Answer: A. Explanation: Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q58. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Connectivity?

A. State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions. B. Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. C. An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category. D. MoEFCC's retrievable wildlife page confirmed the four categories and protection outside protected areas, but its undated displayed count was not adopted as the latest network total.

Answer: B. Explanation: Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q59. Which statement uses Connectivity without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category. B. MoEFCC's retrievable wildlife page confirmed the four categories and protection outside protected areas, but its undated displayed count was not adopted as the latest network total. C. Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. D. Routed demands cover named parks, habitats, community-reserve governance and Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar as separate designation functions; no objective key is inferred.

Answer: C. Explanation: Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Connectivity?

A. MoEFCC's retrievable wildlife page confirmed the four categories and protection outside protected areas, but its undated displayed count was not adopted as the latest network total. B. Routed demands cover named parks, habitats, community-reserve governance and Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar as separate designation functions; no objective key is inferred. C. The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category. D. Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape.

Answer: D. Explanation: Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Boundary alteration safeguards?

A. The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked. B. State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions. C. An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category. D. MoEFCC's retrievable wildlife page confirmed the four categories and protection outside protected areas, but its undated displayed count was not adopted as the latest network total.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q62. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Boundary alteration safeguards?

A. An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category. B. The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked. C. MoEFCC's retrievable wildlife page confirmed the four categories and protection outside protected areas, but its undated displayed count was not adopted as the latest network total. D. Routed demands cover named parks, habitats, community-reserve governance and Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar as separate designation functions; no objective key is inferred.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q63. Which statement uses Boundary alteration safeguards without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. MoEFCC's retrievable wildlife page confirmed the four categories and protection outside protected areas, but its undated displayed count was not adopted as the latest network total. B. Routed demands cover named parks, habitats, community-reserve governance and Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar as separate designation functions; no objective key is inferred. C. The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked. D. The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Boundary alteration safeguards?

A. Routed demands cover named parks, habitats, community-reserve governance and Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar as separate designation functions; no objective key is inferred. B. The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category. C. A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification. D. The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Authorities and jurisdiction?

A. State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions. B. An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category. C. MoEFCC's retrievable wildlife page confirmed the four categories and protection outside protected areas, but its undated displayed count was not adopted as the latest network total. D. Routed demands cover named parks, habitats, community-reserve governance and Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar as separate designation functions; no objective key is inferred.

Answer: A. Explanation: State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q66. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Authorities and jurisdiction?

A. MoEFCC's retrievable wildlife page confirmed the four categories and protection outside protected areas, but its undated displayed count was not adopted as the latest network total. B. State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions. C. Routed demands cover named parks, habitats, community-reserve governance and Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar as separate designation functions; no objective key is inferred. D. The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category.

Answer: B. Explanation: State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q67. Which statement uses Authorities and jurisdiction without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Routed demands cover named parks, habitats, community-reserve governance and Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar as separate designation functions; no objective key is inferred. B. The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category. C. State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions. D. A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification.

Answer: C. Explanation: State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Authorities and jurisdiction?

A. The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category. B. A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification. C. A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. D. State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions.

Answer: D. Explanation: State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies OECM distinction?

A. An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category. B. MoEFCC's retrievable wildlife page confirmed the four categories and protection outside protected areas, but its undated displayed count was not adopted as the latest network total. C. Routed demands cover named parks, habitats, community-reserve governance and Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar as separate designation functions; no objective key is inferred. D. The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category.

Answer: A. Explanation: An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q70. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of OECM distinction?

A. Routed demands cover named parks, habitats, community-reserve governance and Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar as separate designation functions; no objective key is inferred. B. An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category. C. The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category. D. A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification.

Answer: B. Explanation: An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q71. Which statement uses OECM distinction without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category. B. A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification. C. An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category. D. A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park.

Answer: C. Explanation: An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about OECM distinction?

A. A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification. B. A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. C. A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. D. An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category.

Answer: D. Explanation: An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Live official network boundary?

A. MoEFCC's retrievable wildlife page confirmed the four categories and protection outside protected areas, but its undated displayed count was not adopted as the latest network total. B. Routed demands cover named parks, habitats, community-reserve governance and Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar as separate designation functions; no objective key is inferred. C. The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category. D. A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification.

Answer: A. Explanation: MoEFCC's retrievable wildlife page confirmed the four categories and protection outside protected areas, but its undated displayed count was not adopted as the latest network total. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q74. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Live official network boundary?

A. The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category. B. MoEFCC's retrievable wildlife page confirmed the four categories and protection outside protected areas, but its undated displayed count was not adopted as the latest network total. C. A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification. D. A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park.

Answer: B. Explanation: MoEFCC's retrievable wildlife page confirmed the four categories and protection outside protected areas, but its undated displayed count was not adopted as the latest network total. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q75. Which statement uses Live official network boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification. B. A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. C. MoEFCC's retrievable wildlife page confirmed the four categories and protection outside protected areas, but its undated displayed count was not adopted as the latest network total. D. A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities.

Answer: C. Explanation: MoEFCC's retrievable wildlife page confirmed the four categories and protection outside protected areas, but its undated displayed count was not adopted as the latest network total. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Live official network boundary?

A. A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. B. A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. C. A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. D. MoEFCC's retrievable wildlife page confirmed the four categories and protection outside protected areas, but its undated displayed count was not adopted as the latest network total.

Answer: D. Explanation: MoEFCC's retrievable wildlife page confirmed the four categories and protection outside protected areas, but its undated displayed count was not adopted as the latest network total. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ and designation route?

A. Routed demands cover named parks, habitats, community-reserve governance and Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar as separate designation functions; no objective key is inferred. B. The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category. C. A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification. D. A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park.

Answer: A. Explanation: Routed demands cover named parks, habitats, community-reserve governance and Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar as separate designation functions; no objective key is inferred. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ and designation route?", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ and designation route?".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ and designation route? **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A. Routed demands cover named parks, habitats, community-reserve governance and Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar as separate designation functions; no objective key is inferred. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** B. The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** C. A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** D. A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ and designation route?".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ and designation route?", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ and designation route?

A. A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification. B. Routed demands cover named parks, habitats, community-reserve governance and Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar as separate designation functions; no objective key is inferred. C. A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. D. A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities.

Answer: B. Explanation: Routed demands cover named parks, habitats, community-reserve governance and Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar as separate designation functions; no objective key is inferred. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Demand decoding: Treat "Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ and designation route?" as a taxon, ecological mechanism, legal category, institution, treaty/status, parameter, unit, chronology and source-date problem.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ and designation route?".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ and designation route? **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A. A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** B. Routed demands cover named parks, habitats, community-reserve governance and Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar as separate designation functions; no objective key is inferred. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** C. A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** D. A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ and designation route?".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the system/taxon and scale; mark stock/flow and unit; identify the competent law, institution or treaty status; test each statement against mechanism, date, jurisdiction and closest exception.

Why this earns marks: It prevents ecological categories, species statuses, legal schedules, treaty appendices, standards and policy stages from being conflated.

How to improve this answer: For "Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ and designation route?", explain why the closest distractor fails on mechanism, scale, taxon, unit, mandate, legal/treaty status, date or causation.

Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ and designation route without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. B. A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. C. Routed demands cover named parks, habitats, community-reserve governance and Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar as separate designation functions; no objective key is inferred. D. A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role.

Answer: C. Explanation: Routed demands cover named parks, habitats, community-reserve governance and Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar as separate designation functions; no objective key is inferred. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ and designation route without changing its scale,...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ and designation route without changing its scale, parameter or status?".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ and designation route without changing its scale, parameter or status? **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A. A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** B. A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** C. Routed demands cover named parks, habitats, community-reserve governance and Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar as separate designation functions; no objective key is inferred. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** D. A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ and designation route without changing its scale, parameter or status?".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ and designation route without changing its scale,...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ and designation route?

A. A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. B. A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. C. Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area. D. Routed demands cover named parks, habitats, community-reserve governance and Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar as separate designation functions; no objective key is inferred.

Answer: D. Explanation: Routed demands cover named parks, habitats, community-reserve governance and Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar as separate designation functions; no objective key is inferred. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Demand decoding: Treat "Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ and..." as a taxon, ecological mechanism, legal category, institution, treaty/status, parameter, unit, chronology and source-date problem.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ and designation route?".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ and designation route? **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A. A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** B. A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** C. Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** D. Routed demands cover named parks, habitats, community-reserve governance and Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar as separate designation functions; no objective key is inferred. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ and designation route?".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the system/taxon and scale; mark stock/flow and unit; identify the competent law, institution or treaty status; test each statement against mechanism, date, jurisdiction and closest exception.

Why this earns marks: It prevents ecological categories, species statuses, legal schedules, treaty appendices, standards and policy stages from being conflated.

How to improve this answer: For "Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ and...", explain why the closest distractor fails on mechanism, scale, taxon, unit, mandate, legal/treaty status, date or causation.

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Audited ledgers route named parks and habitats, Community Reserve governance, a 2023 GS-I sanctuary demand and a provisional 2026 Madhav National Park, Tiger Reserve and Sakhya Sagar distinction. The Mains demand receives an independently authored model; objective keys, current counts and unstated legal boundaries are not inferred.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: Recurring Prelims pattern: match the correct permitted-activity level to each protected-area category and identify which categories require community/private-land consent.
- ANALYSIS: Mains linkage: corridor connectivity (via Conservation Reserves) and community-based conservation (via Community Reserves) are used to argue for a landscape, not island-reserve, conservation approach.

2026 PYQ Integration

> **Status:** 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: `_PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md`. **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2026	Prelims GS-I	32	Madhav National Park, tiger reserve status, and Sakhya Sagar	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (`Ans-■2026-■GS1-■Provisional`); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Madhav National Park, tiger reserve status, and Sakhya Sagar

> This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

> **Status:** Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: `_PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md`, `_PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md`. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2020, 2023
- **Paper(s):** GS-I, Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 8

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	Prelims GS-I	94	Pakhui Wildlife Sanctuary state location in India	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	Prelims GS-I	18	National Parks located in temperate alpine zone	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	Prelims GS-I	73	Protected areas located in Cauvery river basin	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	Prelims GS-I	75	Protected area for hard ground Barasingha swamp deer	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	Prelims GS-I	95	Desert National Park districts habitation and GIB habitat	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	Prelims GS-I	100	Tiger Reserves with largest Critical Tiger Habitat area	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	GS-I	15	Diversity of natural vegetation and rain forest wildlife sanctuaries	Identify and discuss and assess · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	Prelims GS-I	38	Community Reserve governance hunting NTFP agricultural rights	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Pakhui Wildlife Sanctuary state location in India
- National Parks located in temperate alpine zone
- Protected areas located in Cauvery river basin
- Protected area for hard ground Barasingha swamp deer
- Desert National Park districts habitation and GIB habitat
- Tiger Reserves with largest Critical Tiger Habitat area
- Diversity of natural vegetation and rain forest wildlife sanctuaries
- Community Reserve governance hunting NTFP agricultural rights

> The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: Prelims statement-based questions on protected-area categories often test the

legal-consent distinction (Community Reserve consent-based vs National Park exclusion- based) - apply this consent/exclusion axis to eliminate incorrect options quickly.

- ANALYSIS: Mains answers on "protected area management" should explicitly engage the rightsversus-conservation tension (Section 2) rather than presenting protected-area expansion as an uncomplicated conservation success metric.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

> **Status:** Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: `_PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md`.

- **Years represented:** 2023
- **Paper(s):** GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2023	GS-I	15	Diversity of natural vegetation and rain forest wildlife sanctuaries	Identify and discuss and assess · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Diversity of natural vegetation and rain forest wildlife sanctuaries

> The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2023 GS-I Q15

Demand: Diversity of natural vegetation and the role of rain-forest wildlife sanctuaries.

Status: Routed from an audited official-paper ledger; model answer independently authored.

Model solution: Wildlife Sanctuary: A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. **Boundary and surrounding landscape:** The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact. **Connectivity:** Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. **Authorities and jurisdiction:** State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2023 GS-I Q15", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Wildlife Sanctuary: A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. **Boundary and surrounding landscape:** The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact. **Connectivity:** Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. **Authorities and jurisdiction:** State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Diversity of natural vegetation and the role of rain-forest wildlife sanctuaries. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:**

State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Routed from an audited official-paper ledger; model answer independently authored. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Wildlife Sanctuary: A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. **Boundary and surrounding landscape:** The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact. **Connectivity:** Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. **Authorities and jurisdiction:** State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2023 GS-I Q15", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish India's four protected-area categories. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Four protected-area categories. **Named evidence/example:** The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** National Park. **Named evidence/example:** A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Wildlife Sanctuary. **Named evidence/example:** A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Conservation Reserve. **Named evidence/example:** A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Community

Reserve. **Named evidence/example:** A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category.
- A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification.
- A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park.
- A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities.
- A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Four protected-area categories. **Named evidence/example:** The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** National Park. **Named evidence/example:** A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Wildlife Sanctuary. **Named evidence/example:** A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Conservation Reserve. **Named evidence/example:** A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Community Reserve. **Named evidence/example:** A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish India's four protected-area categories. Answer in about 150 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Four protected-area categories. **Named evidence/example:** The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** National Park. **Named evidence/example:** A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Wildlife Sanctuary. **Named evidence/example:** A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Conservation Reserve. **Named evidence/example:** A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Community Reserve. **Named evidence/example:** A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Four protected-area categories. **Named evidence/example:** The owner separates National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve under the Wildlife Protection Act; they are not one uniform land category. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** National Park. **Named evidence/example:** A National Park uses the strictest of the four owner-described regimes; rights, grazing, entry and activities remain governed by the Act and the area's notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Wildlife Sanctuary. **Named evidence/example:** A Wildlife Sanctuary protects wildlife and habitat while permitting a different, generally less restrictive rights and regulated-activity settlement than a National Park. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Conservation Reserve. **Named evidence/example:** A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Community Reserve. **Named evidence/example:** A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish India's four protected-area categories. Answer in about 150 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Why were Conservation and Community Reserves added? Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Conservation Reserve. **Named evidence/example:** A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Community Reserve. **Named evidence/example:** A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** 2002 category expansion. **Named evidence/example:** The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities.
- A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role.
- The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Conservation Reserve. **Named evidence/example:** A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Community Reserve. **Named evidence/example:** A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** 2002 category expansion. **Named evidence/example:** The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Why were Conservation and Community Reserves added? Answer in about 150 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Conservation Reserve. **Named evidence/example:** A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Community Reserve. **Named evidence/example:** A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** 2002 category expansion. **Named evidence/example:** The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Conservation Reserve. **Named evidence/example:** A Conservation Reserve is a statutory connector or buffer category generally associated with government land and consultation with local communities. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Community Reserve. **Named evidence/example:** A Community Reserve is a consent-based category on community or private land with a continuing local management role. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** 2002 category expansion. **Named evidence/example:** The owner attributes Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves to the 2002 amendment, extending conservation beyond exclusion-oriented core categories. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Why were Conservation and Community Reserves added? Answer in about 150 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Explain Tiger Reserve overlay, core-buffer design and rights safeguards. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Tiger Reserve overlay. **Named evidence/example:** A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Critical tiger habitat and buffer. **Named evidence/example:** The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Relocation and rights. **Named evidence/example:** The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status.
- The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific.
- The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Tiger Reserve overlay. **Named evidence/example:** A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Critical tiger habitat and buffer. **Named evidence/example:** The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Relocation and rights. **Named evidence/example:** The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain Tiger Reserve overlay, core-buffer design and rights safeguards. Answer in about 250...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Tiger Reserve overlay. **Named evidence/example:** A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Critical tiger habitat and buffer. **Named evidence/example:** The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Relocation and rights. **Named evidence/example:** The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Tiger Reserve overlay. **Named evidence/example:** A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Critical tiger habitat and buffer. **Named evidence/example:** The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Relocation and rights. **Named evidence/example:** The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain Tiger Reserve overlay, core-buffer design and rights safeguards. Answer in about 250...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Distinguish a protected-area boundary, ESZ and ecological corridor. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Eco-Sensitive Zone statute. **Named evidence/example:** An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** ESZ extent and activities. **Named evidence/example:** ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Boundary and surrounding landscape. **Named evidence/example:** The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Connectivity. **Named evidence/example:** Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act.
- ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width.
- The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact.
- Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Eco-Sensitive Zone statute. **Named evidence/example:** An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** ESZ extent and activities. **Named evidence/example:** ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Boundary and surrounding landscape. **Named evidence/example:** The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Connectivity. **Named evidence/example:** Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish a protected-area boundary, ESZ and ecological corridor. Answer in about 250 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Eco-Sensitive Zone statute. **Named evidence/example:** An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** ESZ extent and activities. **Named evidence/example:** ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Boundary and surrounding landscape. **Named evidence/example:** The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Connectivity. **Named evidence/example:** Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Eco-Sensitive Zone statute. **Named evidence/example:** An Eco-Sensitive Zone is separately notified under the Environment Protection Act, not declared as a fifth protected-area category under the Wildlife Protection Act. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** ESZ extent and activities. **Named evidence/example:** ESZ extent and prohibited, regulated or promoted activities come from the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Boundary and surrounding landscape. **Named evidence/example:** The notified protected-area boundary, a separately notified ESZ and the wider ecological corridor are distinct spatial objects even when they interact. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Connectivity. **Named evidence/example:** Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish a protected-area boundary, ESZ and ecological corridor. Answer in about 250 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Critically assess India's protected-area network through rights and connectivity. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Rights and activity gradient. **Named evidence/example:** Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Relocation and rights. **Named evidence/example:** The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Connectivity. **Named evidence/example:** Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Boundary alteration safeguards. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Authorities and jurisdiction. **Named evidence/example:** State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area.
- The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes.
- Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape.
- The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked.
- State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Rights and activity gradient. **Named evidence/example:** Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Relocation and rights. **Named evidence/example:** The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Connectivity. **Named evidence/example:** Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Boundary alteration safeguards. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Authorities and jurisdiction. **Named evidence/example:** State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **critically assess** requires a direct position on "Critically assess India's protected-area network through rights and connectivity. Answer in...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Rights and activity gradient. **Named evidence/example:** Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Relocation and rights. **Named evidence/example:** The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Connectivity. **Named evidence/example:** Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Boundary alteration safeguards. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Authorities and jurisdiction. **Named evidence/example:** State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Rights and activity gradient. **Named evidence/example:** Permitted rights and activities vary by legal category and site-specific notification; strictness cannot be inferred from the generic phrase protected area. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Relocation and rights. **Named evidence/example:** The owner requires voluntary informed consent and rehabilitation for relocation from critical tiger habitat and flags coordination with Forest Rights Act processes.

Analysis: This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Connectivity. **Named evidence/example:** Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Boundary alteration safeguards. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records State Legislature, NBWL and, for Tiger Reserves, NTCA roles in specified boundary alteration or de-notification safeguards; the applicable route must be checked. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Authorities and jurisdiction. **Named evidence/example:** State wildlife authorities manage the four categories, while NBWL, NTCA, WII and MoEFCC perform different approval, species-overlay, scientific and policy functions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Critically assess India's protected-area network through rights and connectivity. Answer in...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Compare tiger and elephant conservation architecture in India. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Tiger Reserve overlay. **Named evidence/example:** A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Critical tiger habitat and buffer. **Named evidence/example:** The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Elephant landscape distinction. **Named evidence/example:** Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Connectivity. **Named evidence/example:** Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** OECM distinction. **Named evidence/example:** An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status.
- The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific.
- Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable.
- Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape.
- An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Tiger Reserve overlay. **Named evidence/example:** A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Critical tiger habitat and buffer. **Named evidence/example:** The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Elephant landscape distinction. **Named evidence/example:** Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Connectivity. **Named evidence/example:** Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** OECM distinction. **Named evidence/example:** An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Demand decoding: The directive **compare** requires a direct position on "Compare tiger and elephant conservation architecture in India. Answer in about 300 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Tiger Reserve overlay. **Named evidence/example:** A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Critical tiger habitat and buffer. **Named evidence/example:** The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Elephant landscape distinction. **Named evidence/example:** Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Connectivity. **Named evidence/example:** Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** OECM distinction. **Named evidence/example:** An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Tiger Reserve overlay. **Named evidence/example:** A Tiger Reserve is a species-management overlay under the NTCA framework and does not erase the underlying National Park, Sanctuary or other land status. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Critical tiger habitat and buffer. **Named evidence/example:** The tiger-reserve model separates core or critical tiger habitat from a buffer or peripheral area; each boundary and management claim must remain site-specific. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Elephant landscape distinction. **Named evidence/example:** Elephant reserves and corridors rely more on landscape coordination than an NTCA-equivalent statutory core-buffer mechanism; the two species models are not interchangeable. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Connectivity. **Named evidence/example:** Corridors, stepping-stone habitats and compatible land use outside protected areas determine whether populations can disperse across a fragmented landscape. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** OECM distinction. **Named evidence/example:** An OECM records sustained area-based conservation outside the formal protected-area system; it is not automatically a Wildlife Protection Act category. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Compare tiger and elephant conservation architecture in India. Answer in about 300 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.